

Knowing about programming design patterns such as MVC and IoC is also important for any developer, as any major software project involving multiple developers will probably use one

If you are very interested in developing user interfaces and designing the way people interact with software, then Interaction Design or IxD is an entire field just for you!

Imaging: Chaitanya Surpur
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Developing... your career

Proud of being an uber geek? Make it a career...

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Developing... an option

The open source community has changed the very way we look at software. The very non-commercial nature of it makes you wonder whether there is any future in software development.

When you see so many people developing software for free, you are sure to get the impression that it isn't a very lucrative career.

However software development is far from a profit-less venture. There are still a large number of companies which develop applications, and provide software services. There is no lack of programming related jobs out there, it is just that the bar has gone up.

Even if you don't intend to take up programming as a career, learning programming languages can be a lot of fun. It is like learning how to speak in another language, it gives you access to another programming culture and community.

Developing... desktop applications

Here, by desktop applications we mean to encompass all conventional computer

platforms, x86, x86_64. For the most part this means programming for Linux, Windows, or Mac OSX.

While most programming languages are capable of targeting any of these platforms, there are some languages which are more platform biased. The core of Linux programming and its kernel itself is written in C and Apple platforms favour Objective-C.

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The number of desktop programming languages is so diverse that it is impossible to learn them all. Yet there are a few that we might constantly run into in our programming endeavours, and a minimal knowledge of them is highly recommended.

All said and done, these are the programming languages that every developer should know:

Java

Java is the most popular programming language, thanks to its wide scope of use.

It espouses the principle of "Write Once, Run Anywhere," meaning that as long as a runtime environment is available for an operating system, the Java application you write will run on it (and the Java Runtime Environment is available for nearly every platform). Java is very popular for enterprise applications and as such is a very good programming language to learn for furthering your career. Java is also used in web programming and programming applications for mobiles, thus making your experience even more portable. Java should not be confused with JavaScript, which is the scripting language of the web, they have very little in common besides their names.

C and C++

The syntactical similarities between C and C++ mean that by learning one, you essentially learn the other. C code will require very little adaptation to compile with a C++ compiler, however the languages differ in paradigms. A large amount of code is still written in the C programming language, and as such you are bound to run into it sooner or later once you start programming – learning C is thus a worthy investment for any programmer.